

BONUS 4 OF 5 · FREE WITH YOUR COLLECTION

How to Price & Sell

Calculate the real cost of every backpack, the margin handmade pieces sell at, phone photos that sell and exactly what to say when someone asks for a discount.

Formula + worked USD examples

Price ladder

8 copy-ready replies

Printable worksheet

BONUS EXCLUSIVE

HOW TO PRICE & SELL

Discover your real value and start selling your handmade pieces with confidence!

Collect, create, and sell with confidence

VALUE \$57

Crochet Creates Real Income

Crochet With Love Low

Good Things Are Handmade

Crochet P-sell Grow

1 PLAN YOUR PRICING

Set your prices based on your costs, the time you invest and the value of your work.

Item	Materials	Labor Time	Suggested Price
Small bag	\$12.00	3.0 hrs	\$36.00
Medium bag	\$18.00	4.0 hrs	\$48.00
Large bag	\$25.00	6.0 hrs	\$72.00
Phone case	\$8.00	2.0 hrs	\$28.00

Cost of materials (example) **\$68.00**

Consider your time, experience and the quality of your work. Your price should reflect the value you bring to your customers.

2 HOW TO MAKE A PROFIT

Set your prices, cover your costs and make a profit, so your business can grow over time.

COST \$17 + MARKUP x3 = SELLING PRICE \$51

PRACTICAL EXAMPLE

Cost of materials	\$17.00
Labor (3 hours)	\$24.00
Total cost per piece	\$41.00
Suggested selling price	\$51.00

Always include your time, profit and the value of your handmade work.

3 PHOTOS THAT SELL

Great photos make a difference! Good images show the quality of your work and build trust with your customers.

- Use natural light**
Better colors and more realistic details.
- Show different angles**
Front, back, close-ups and details of the finish.
- Keep a clean background**
A simple and organized space highlights your product.
- Show the details**
Stitches, texture and unique elements of your piece.

Good photos aren't just pretty — they help your work sell!

4 WHERE AND HOW TO SELL

Take your work to the right places and share it with the right audience. Choose the channels that fit your style and goals.

- Instagram**
Show your creations, share your process and connect with your audience.
- WhatsApp**
Direct sales, fast communication and loyal customers.
- Marketplaces**
Etsy, Amazon Handmade and more.
- Local events**
Craft fairs, markets and pop-up shops.

IDEAS TO SELL MORE

- Offer special bundles or custom orders.
- Discounts for repeat customers.
- Share your story and your brand.
- Keep your shop active and engaged.

More crochet. More happy customers.

What's inside

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SECTION 1

1. The real cost of one backpack

Most makers only count the yarn. That's why they sell a \$75 bag for \$35 and feel tired instead of proud.

A handmade price has three parts: **materials** (everything you bought), **time** (every hour, including finishing and photos) and **fees** (what the platform or card reader keeps).

Materials — medium cotton backpack (28 x 32 x 12 cm / 11 x 12.5 x 4.75 in)

ITEM	QUANTITY	UNIT PRICE (EXAMPLE)	COST
Worsted cotton yarn	320 g (about 5 balls of 70 g)	\$0.05 per gram (\$3.50 a ball)	\$16.00
Slide adjusters + D-rings	2 + 2	\$0.35 each	\$1.40
Magnetic snap 14 mm	1	\$0.50	\$0.50
Lining (quilting cotton)	1/2 of a fat quarter	\$3.40 per fat quarter	\$1.70
Handmade label + tag	1 set	\$0.40	\$0.40
Total materials			\$20.00

Prices are typical 2026 US craft-store and online prices. Replace them with your receipts: the method matters, not these exact numbers. UK/CA/AU/NZ buyers: use the same steps in your own currency.

Time — count all of it

TASK	HOURS (AFTER YOUR 3RD BACKPACK)
Crochet body, flap, straps	4.0
Lining, hardware, weaving in ends	1.0
Photos, listing, packaging	0.5
Total time	5.5 h

THE HONEST-HOURS RULE

Price by your **target time** — how long it takes you after three practice pieces — not your very first backpack. The first one takes 10 hours for everybody; customers shouldn't pay for your learning curve, and you shouldn't give it away either.

SECTION 2

2. The price formula

One line, two checks. Use it on every piece you make.

$$\text{Price} = (\text{Materials} + \text{Hours} \times \text{Hourly rate}) \times 1.10$$

x 1.10 covers platform / card fees, tool wear and packaging (about 10%)

Choose your hourly rate

YOUR LEVEL	HOURLY RATE	WHY
Starting out (first 10 sales)	\$8 / h	Competitive while your photos and reviews grow
Confident (10+ sales, good reviews)	\$10–12 / h	Your finish is consistent; repeat buyers
Known maker / custom work	\$15+ / h	Personalization, waiting list

Worked example — the \$20 backpack

	STARTING OUT	CONFIDENT
Materials		\$20.00
Time	5 h x \$8 = \$40.00	5.5 h x \$10 = \$55.00
Subtotal	\$60.00	\$75.00
x 1.10 (fees & overhead)	\$66.00	\$82.50
List price (rounded)	\$65	\$85

CHECK 1 — THE QUICK MULTIPLE

Materials x 3 to x 4. $\$20 \times 3 = \60 · $\$20 \times 4 = \80 . If your formula price is far below x 3, your hourly rate is too low; if it's above x 5, check your hours.

CHECK 2 — THE MARKET BAND

Search your marketplace for "crochet backpack" and note 10 prices of pieces with photos as good as yours. Handmade cotton backpacks usually sit between \$55 and \$120. Stay inside the band — never at the bottom.

ROUNDING

Round to a clean price: \$65, \$69, \$75, \$79, \$85. Avoid \$64.37. Round **up**, never down.

SECTION 3

3. Price ladder for the whole collection

Same formula, \$8–10/h, x 1.10. Use it to fill a table at a fair or a shop with 3 price levels.

PIECE	MATERIALS	HOURS	AT \$8/H	AT \$10/H	SUGGESTED PRICE
Coin purse (bonus pieces 1–10)	\$3	1.5	\$16.50	\$19.80	\$15–20
Card sleeve / card wallet	\$2	1.5	\$15.40	\$18.70	\$15–19
Zip or bifold wallet	\$5	3.5	\$36.30	\$44.00	\$35–45
Clutch (t-shirt yarn or cotton)	\$10	3	\$37.40	\$44.00	\$38–45
Mini / kids backpack	\$12	4	\$48.40	\$57.20	\$48–58
Medium backpack	\$20	5–5.5	\$66.00	\$82.50	\$65–85
Large backpack (cord or lined cotton)	\$30	7	\$94.60	\$110.00	\$95–110

Three levels sell more than one

GOOD

Unlined backpack, standard color.

Example: \$65

BETTER

Lined + inner pocket + webbing straps.

Example: \$79

BEST

Lined + **matching coin purse** + initial charm.

Example: \$95

Most buyers choose the middle option. The top option makes the middle one look reasonable, and the bottom one gives price-sensitive buyers a way in.

Add-ons

ADD-ON	EXTRA TIME	ADD
Initial / name patch	30 min	+\$8
Matching coin purse (bundle)	1.5 h	+\$15 (instead of \$19 alone)
Lining + inner pocket	45 min + \$2	+\$12
Custom color not in stock	shopping + wait	+10%
Rush (ready in under 7 days)	reorganizing	+20%

SECTION 4

4. Margin, fees & custom orders

What you really keep on a \$75 sale

	AMOUNT
Price	\$75.00
Materials	– \$20.00
Fees (about 10% on most online marketplaces; card readers at fairs ~3%)	– \$7.50
What pays your 5.5 hours	\$47.50 (63% of the price)

MARGIN RULE

Materials should be 25–35% of your price. Above 40%, the price is too low or the yarn is too expensive for that product. Local pickup with cash or a payment app has no fees — but keep the same price everywhere.

Custom orders — the 5 rules

- 1 50% deposit before you start**, non-refundable once the yarn is bought. The rest before delivery.
- 2 Write the order down** and send it back for a "yes": size, colors, lining, extras, price, delivery date.
- 3 One free change** before you start. Changes after you start are billed at your hourly rate.
- 4 Delivery date = your estimate + 5 days.** Delivering early delights; delivering late loses the review.
- 5 Send a progress photo** halfway. It makes the second payment easy.

Group orders (e.g. 6 backpacks for a class or team)

QUANTITY	DISCOUNT	WHY IT'S FAIR
1–4	0%	Normal price
5–9	10%	Same pattern and color: faster per piece
10+	15% max	Only with 50% deposit and a delivery date you control

SECTION 5

5. Phone photos that sell

Buyers can't touch the bag. The photo is the texture, the size and the quality — all at once.



The setup (costs about \$5)

- **Light:** a big window, indirect daylight, between 10 am and 4 pm. Turn OFF every ceiling lamp (yellow cast).
- **Reflector:** a white foam board on the side opposite the window fills the shadows.
- **Background:** white or cream wall, a linen sheet, or a light wooden table. Nothing else in the frame.
- **Stuffing:** fill the backpack with a pillow or tissue paper so it stands and shows its real shape.

Phone settings

- Main 1x camera or 2x — **never the 0.5 wide lens** (it distorts the shape).
- Grid on. Tap the bag to focus, then slide exposure down a touch so white stitches don't burn.
- Portrait mode off for product shots; flash always off.
- Shoot vertical and leave space around the bag, so every platform's square crop works.

The 7 photos every listing needs

#	SHOT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
1	Front, 3/4 angle, stuffed, eye level	"Do I like it?" — this is the thumbnail
2	Back with straps	"Is it comfortable? Are the straps adjustable?"
3	Side / depth	"How much fits?"
4	Inside: lining + pocket, top open	"Is it well made?"
5	Stitch close-up (fill the frame)	"Is it really handmade? What's the texture?"

#	SHOT	WHAT IT ANSWERS
6	Hardware close-up (zipper, snap, rings)	"Will it last?"
7	Scale: worn, or next to a book / water bottle	"How big is it really?"

EDITING

Edit only three things: brightness up, shadows up, white balance to true color. **No filters.** A buyer who receives a different color than the photo returns the bag.

SECTION 6

6. The listing: title, description, care card

Copy these templates and replace the brackets.

Title formula

[Style] Crochet Backpack · [Material] · [Size] · [Key feature] · Handmade

Example: Boho Crochet Backpack · Cotton · Medium 11 × 12.5 in · Lined with Adjustable Straps · Handmade

Description template

COPY & PASTE

Handmade crochet backpack in [color] [material], made by me stitch by stitch.

- ✓ Size: [W x H x D cm] / [W x H x D in]
- ✓ Fully lined in cotton with an inside pocket
- ✓ Adjustable straps with [webbing / leather] core — they don't stretch
- ✓ [Magnetic snap / zipper] closure · [gold] hardware
- ✓ Fits: [a tablet / a water bottle, wallet and phone]

Every piece is made to order in [X] days. Colors may vary slightly between yarn batches.

Care: hand wash cold, dry flat in the shade.

Care card (print, cut, put inside every bag)

Made by hand, just for you ♥

Hand wash in cold water with mild soap · Do not wring · Reshape and dry flat in the shade · Do not iron over the hardware · Spot clean the lining with a damp cloth.

Made by hand, just for you ♥

Hand wash in cold water with mild soap · Do not wring · Reshape and dry flat in the shade · Do not iron over the hardware · Spot clean the lining with a damp cloth.

Before you publish a listing

- ☐ Title has style, material, size and one feature
- ☐ Size in cm AND inches
- ☐ 7 photos, first one bright and centered
- ☐ Price checked with the formula and the market band
- ☐ Delivery time stated (made-to-order days)
- ☐ Care instructions included

SECTION 7

7. What to say when someone asks for a discount

Never apologize for your price. Offer a choice instead of a lower number.

"CAN YOU DO \$50?" (LISTED AT \$75)

Thank you for loving it! The price covers the cotton, the lining and about 5 hours of work, so I keep it at \$75. If you'd like something closer to \$50, the mini version is \$52 and comes in the same colors.

"I SAW ONE CHEAPER ONLINE / IN A STORE"

You're right, there are cheaper machine-made bags. Mine is crocheted by hand, lined, with straps reinforced so they don't stretch. That's the difference you'll feel after a year of use.

"FRIENDS & FAMILY PRICE?"

I love that you want one! For friends I include the matching coin purse as a gift — the backpack stays at \$75.

"IF I BUY TWO, WHAT'S THE PRICE?"

For two I can do \$140 instead of \$150, and both are made in the same yarn batch so the colors match perfectly.

"COULD YOU MAKE IT JUST FOR THE COST OF MATERIALS?"

I understand! The materials are only a small part — most of it is the hours of work. If budget is tight, the unlined version is \$65 and has the same stitches.

END OF A FAIR: "WILL YOU TAKE \$40?"

I can't go that low on this one, but I can do \$65 today with free initial charm — that's my fair special.

"I'LL THINK ABOUT IT"

Of course! It's made to order, so just let me know which color and I'll reserve a spot for you this week.

"CAN YOU DO 15 FOR OUR SCHOOL FOR \$30 EACH?"

What a lovely project! For 10+ pieces my group price is 15% off: \$64 each, with a 50% deposit and delivery in [X] weeks. I can also suggest a smaller size at \$48 each if you need a lower budget.

THE PRINCIPLE

Discount is a **choice** you design in advance (bundle, smaller size, fewer extras, a gift), not a number you drop under pressure. Write your 3 fallback offers before every fair.

SECTION 8

8. Printable pricing worksheet

Print one per product. Keep them in a folder next to your yarn.

LINE	YOUR NUMBERS
Product name / size	
Yarn: grams x price per gram	____ g x \$____ = \$____
Hardware (zipper, snaps, rings, slides)	\$____
Lining + interfacing	\$____
Label, tag, packaging	\$____
A. Total materials	\$____
Hours: crochet + finishing + photos	____ h
Hourly rate	\$____ / h
B. Labor = hours x rate	\$____
C. (A + B) x 1.10	\$____
Check 1: A x 3 = ____ · A x 4 = ____	In range? ☐ yes ☐ no
Check 2: market band (10 similar listings)	\$____ to \$____
FINAL PRICE (rounded up)	\$____
Materials as % of price (A ÷ price)	____ % (target 25–35%)
Good / Better / Best versions	\$____ / \$____ / \$____

My 3 fallback offers (instead of a discount)

☐ Smaller size at: \$____

☐ Bundle offer: _____

☐ Gift add-on: _____

Price it like it's worth it.

Because it is. Use the worksheet for every new piece and keep your three fallback offers ready — you'll never have to lower your price again.

The Crochet Backpack Collection